The Hindu
EDITORIAL ANALYSIS

10th February 2025

PREPARE FOR BANK (PO/ CLERK), SSC,UPSC, State PSC, CAT,CTET,RAILWAY EXAMS,CDS, TET, NDA/AIRFORCE, NET and all Govt. Exams

VOCABULARY

1. Meagre (अल्प)

Meaning: Lacking in quantity or quality; insufficient.
Synonyms: Scanty, insufficient, paltry
Antonyms: Abundant, ample, plentiful
Example: The workers were dissatisfied with the meagre wages they received for their hard work.

2. Bottlenecks (रुकावटें)

Meaning: Points of congestion or blockage that slow down progress.
Synonyms: Hindrances, obstacles, impediments
Antonyms: Smooth flow, clearance, ease
Example: The government is working on removing bottlenecks in the supply chain to ensure timely delivery of goods.

VOCABULARY

3. Synergy (सहयोग)

Meaning: The combined effect of two or more elements that is greater than the sum of their individual effects.
Synonyms: Cooperation, collaboration, harmony
Antonyms: Discord, conflict, opposition
Example: The synergy between the public and private sectors has led to significant advancements in defence manufacturing.

4. Unprecedented (अभूतपूर्व)

Meaning: Never done or known before.
Synonyms: Unparalleled, extraordinary, novel
Antonyms: Common, ordinary, usual
Example: The pandemic led to unprecedented changes in the way businesses operate.

VOCABULARY

5. Prowess (कौशल)

Meaning: Exceptional skill or expertise in a particular field.
Synonyms: Mastery, competence, excellence
Antonyms: Incompetence, weakness, inability
Example: His prowess in artificial intelligence research earned him global recognition.

6. Lofty (उच्च)

Meaning: Of imposing height; noble or ambitious but difficult to achieve.
Synonyms: Grand, elevated, ambitious
Antonyms: Humble, lowly, modest
Example: His lofty aspirations of becoming an astronaut required years of rigorous training.

VOCABULARY

7. Envisage (परिकल्पना करना)

Meaning: To imagine or predict a future possibility.
Synonyms: Foresee, anticipate, conceptualize
Antonyms: Ignore, disregard, dismiss
Example: The government envisages India becoming a global leader in aerospace technology within the next decade.

8. Murky (अस्पष्ट/गंदा)

Meaning: Not clear; obscure or suspiciously unclear.
Synonyms: Opaque, obscure, ambiguous, dubious
Antonyms: Clear, transparent, explicit
Example: The administration's murky stance on defining forests has raised concerns among environmentalists.

VOCABULARY

9. Exuberant (उत्साही)

Meaning: Full of energy, excitement, and cheerfulness.
Synonyms: Lively, enthusiastic, buoyant.
Antonyms: Gloomy, lethargic, subdued.
Example: The children were exuberant during the school's annual festival.

10. Trivial (तुच्छ)

Meaning: Of little importance or value.
Synonyms: Insignificant, minor, negligible.
Antonyms: Significant, important, critical.
Example: He dismissed the issue as trivial, but it turned out to be a major problem.

VOCABULARY

One-word substitutes

1. Present, appearing, or found everywhere:
Ubiquitous

2. Fond of company; sociable:
Gregarious

3. Very generous or forgiving, especially toward a rival or less powerful person:
Magnanimous

4. No longer in use; out of date:
Obsolete

VOCABULARY

Phrasal Verbs:

1. Scrape along
Meaning: Manage with little money

2. Screen out
Meaning: Exclude

3. Screw up
Meaning: Do badly or fail

4. Set about
Meaning: Start doing something

VOCABULARY

Idioms & Phrases

1. Acid test

Meaning: proves the effectiveness of something

2. Back to basics

Meaning: returning to the simple and most important things

3. Against the clock

Meaning: being rushed and having little time to complete something.

VOCABULARY

4. Bad apple

Meaning: a discontented, troublemaking, or dishonest person

5. Bee in one's bonnet

Meaning: be preoccupied or obsessed with something

Article for Reading

A gift horse’s teeth: on allocations and scientific research

The Budget 2025-26 announcements suggest a potential bonanza for scientific research and development. The Finance Minister outlined ₹20,000 crore budgetary support for developing small modular reactors, with the goal of readying five such reactors by 2033. Another major initiative is the Research, Development, and Innovation fund, included in the Department of Science and Technology (DST)'s expected expenditure. This substantial allocation is expected to benefit start-ups and sunrise sectors, though these remain undefined. The expectation is that private sector entities will receive financial support to boost R&D, a domain historically dominated by government spending. India's R&D landscape has long suffered from low private sector participation. While government funding has driven most scientific advancements, private investment in research has remained inadequate.

Currently, private sector R&D contribution is only 36%; overall R&D spending in India was 0.64% of GDP in 2020, the lowest since 1995. Over the last five years, business enterprises have accounted for around 40% of government R&D expenditure. Public sector R&D units allocated only 0.30% of their sales turnover to research, compared to 1.46% by the private sector in 2020-21, according to DST estimates. The government's ₹20,000 crore infusion hikes the DST's total budgetary allocation to around ₹28,000 crore, over three times last year's allocation and seven times the actual expenditure in 2023-24. These figures are encouraging, but a key concern is whether such massive investments can be effectively absorbed. Despite India's strengths in technology-driven sectors such as fuel, metallurgy, pharmaceuticals, textiles, IT, and biotechnology, returns from core R&D and intellectual property generation are still meagre.

Though the government has launched ambitious missions in quantum computing, artificial intelligence, and other cutting-edge technologies, the supporting infrastructure remains inadequate. India still lacks the essential building blocks, chipsets, semiconductor fabs, a skilled engineering workforce, and a strong innovation ecosystem, to fully capitalise on these investments. Without these, the lofty targets set for R&D growth risk falling short. The government must present a clear road map on how private sector entities can access these funds and what tangible benefits the public can expect. Increased funding alone will not guarantee success unless structural bottlenecks are addressed. To truly transform India into a research powerhouse, the focus must shift to strengthening foundational infrastructure, incentivising private innovation, and ensuring long-term, sustainable engagement from industry leaders.

Summary

The Budget 2025-26 introduces a significant boost for research and development (R&D) in India, with ₹20,000 crore allocated for small modular reactors and a substantial increase in the Department of Science and Technology's (DST) budget. A new Research, Development, and Innovation fund aims to encourage private sector participation in R&D, which has historically been dominated by government spending. Despite these investments, concerns remain about their effective absorption due to infrastructural gaps, low private sector involvement, and inadequate innovation ecosystems. While India has strengths in technology-driven sectors, core R&D and intellectual property generation remain weak. The government must provide a clear framework for fund utilization and address structural challenges to ensure meaningful advancements in research and innovation.

Tone:

The tone of the passage is analytical and cautiously optimistic. While it acknowledges the significant increase in funding for R&D, it also highlights concerns about infrastructural deficiencies and private sector participation, emphasizing the need for a strategic approach to ensure effective implementation.

Reading Comprehension

Based on the above passage, answer the following questions:

Question 1:
What is a significant challenge in India's R&D sector despite recent advancements?

a) Lack of essential infrastructure and key components like chipsets and semiconductor fabs
b) Limited international collaborations in cutting-edge technologies
c) Over-reliance on private sector funding for innovation
d) A shortage of research institutions dedicated to biotechnology
e) None of the above

Question 2:
What structural bottleneck must be addressed to ensure effective R&D growth?

a) Reducing the involvement of government agencies in research funding
b) Enhancing foundational infrastructure and incentivizing private sector innovation
c) Increasing the sales turnover of public sector R&D units
d) Redirecting R&D investment towards military applications
e) None of the above

Question 3:
According to the passage, how does India's private sector R&D spending compare to global trends?

a) It is significantly higher than the global average
b) It exceeds the government's contribution in recent years
c) It is comparable to leading research-driven economies like the U.S. and China
d) It remains low, with government spending dominating R&D
e) None of the above

Article for Skimming

An aerospace expo to further India’s global presence

Aero India 2025, which is being held at the Indian Air Force station at Yelahanka in Bengaluru (February 10-14), is more than just an exhibition. It is a platform for innovation, strategic alliances, and technological advancement. The edition this year promises to redefine the standards of aerospace expositions and elevate India's global presence in the aviation sector. As the 15th edition, the show is set to become a landmark event in India's journey towards self-reliance in defence production. Under the leadership of the Prime Minister, Narendra Modi, this premier air show has grown to become a global hub for aerospace innovation, collaboration, and strategic partnerships. The theme this year, 'The Runway to a Billion Opportunities', encapsulates India's commitment to fostering cutting-edge advancements in defence technology while opening new doors for international collaboration. As the Secretary (Defence Production), it is a matter of great pride for this writer to witness the remarkable transformation of India's aerospace and defence manufacturing capabilities.

What began in 1996 as a modest aviation exposition, has, today, evolved into one of the most significant global defence events. With an ever-increasing footprint, Aero India now attracts top-tier defence manufacturers, policymakers, industry leaders and visionaries from across the world. Past editions have witnessed extensive participation from industry players and innovators, and Aero India 2025 is poised to surpass milestones, serving as a dynamic platform to propel India's defence production and technological prowess onto the global stage. Aero India 2025 is set to witness participation from leading global and domestic defence manufacturers, reaffirming its status as a premier defence and aerospace exhibition. A total of 106 original equipment manufacturers (OEMs), including 55 foreign OEMs from 19 countries such as Brazil, France, Israel, Japan, Russia, South Korea, the United Kingdom and the United States have already confirmed their presence. Sixteen defence public sector undertakings (DPSUs) have also confirmed their participation.

Additionally, 35 Indian OEMs, including industry giants such as Larsen & Toubro, Bharat Forge Ltd, Adani Defence & Aerospace, Mahindra Defence Systems Limited, BrahMos Aerospace, Ashok Leyland Defence, Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited (BHEL), and Electronics Corporation of India Limited (ECIL), will showcase their cutting-edge advancements, reflecting the growing synergy between the public and private sectors in bolstering India's defence manufacturing ecosystem. For the first time, the exposition will feature two of the world's most advanced fighter jets, the Russian Su-57 and the American F-35. These cutting-edge aircraft will offer aviation experts and enthusiasts a rare opportunity to analyse their capabilities and performance. The Su-57 is engineered for superior stealth and agility, and the F-35 is renowned for its technological superiority. This unprecedented participation signals India's role as a central player in global defence diplomacy and aerospace progress.

Question 4
What makes Aero India 2025 historically significant in terms of aircraft displays?

a) It is the first airshow in Asia to feature unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs)
b) The Su-57 and F-35 will be showcased together for the first time
c) It is the largest air display ever conducted in India
d) The event will feature an exclusive showcase of Indian-made fighter jets
e) None of the above

Question 5:
What does the theme "The Runway to a Billion Opportunities" signify?

a) India's ambition to develop a billion-dollar aviation industry
b) The increasing employment opportunities in the aviation sector
c) India’s commitment to fostering defence technology advancements and collaborations
d) The government’s plan to launch one billion defence projects
e) None of the above

Today's Descriptive Question

Original Text:

The silver economy refers to the economic opportunities and challenges associated with an aging population. As life expectancy rises and birth rates decline, many countries are experiencing a demographic shift toward an older population. This shift has significant implications for healthcare, employment, consumer markets, and government policies.

The silver economy encompasses industries that cater to the needs of senior citizens, including healthcare, financial services, assistive technologies, housing, and leisure activities.

With older individuals having higher disposable incomes and specific needs, businesses are adapting by offering age-friendly products, such as smart healthcare devices, retirement planning services, and accessible infrastructure. Governments are also recognizing the importance of the silver economy. Policies promoting active aging, skill development for older workers, and healthcare innovations can help sustain economic growth while improving the quality of life for seniors. Many countries are investing in geriatric healthcare, social security programs, and digital literacy initiatives to ensure that older citizens remain active participants in society.However, challenges remain, including rising healthcare costs, pension sustainability, and workforce shortages due to declining younger populations. Addressing these issues requires a multi-sectoral approach, combining public policies with private-sector innovation to create a sustainable and inclusive economy for aging societies.

Precis:

The silver economy focuses on economic opportunities arising from an aging population, impacting healthcare, finance, housing, and technology. With seniors having higher disposable incomes, businesses are adapting to their needs, while governments invest in healthcare, social security, and digital literacy.

Despite opportunities, challenges like rising healthcare costs and pension sustainability persist. A balanced approach involving policy reforms and private-sector innovations is crucial for creating an inclusive and sustainable economy for aging societies.

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To: …….@gmail.com

Subject: Acceptance of Job Offer – [Your Name]

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I hope this email finds you well. I am pleased to formally accept the job offer for the position of [Job Title] at ABC Corporation. I appreciate the opportunity and am excited to contribute to the team.

Kindly provide details regarding the next steps, including any required documentation, onboarding procedures, and my start date. Please let me know if there are any forms or formalities I need to complete before joining.

Thank you once again for this opportunity. I look forward to being a part of ABC Corporation.

Best regards,
[Your Name]
[Your Contact Information]

Match the column

1. Acid test	A. being rushed
2. Back to basics	B. a dishonest person
3. Against the clock	C. be preoccupied or obsessed with something
4. Bad apple	D. proves the effectiveness of something
5. Bee in one's bonnet	E. returning to the most important things

Answer:

1-d

2-e

3-a

4-b

5-c

Vocabulary

1. Meagre:
2. Bottlenecks:
3. Synergy:
4. Unprecedented:
5. Prowess:
6. Lofty:
7. Envisage:
8. Murky:
9. Exuberant:
10. Trivial:

RC ANS

1.

Ans: a

Explanation:

The passage explicitly mentions that India still lacks crucial technological infrastructure, including chipsets, semiconductor fabs, and a skilled engineering workforce, which are essential for R&D growth.

Reference:

"India still lacks the essential building blocks, chipsets, semiconductor fabs, a skilled engineering workforce, and a strong innovation ecosystem, to fully capitalise on these investments."

Why other options are incorrect?

b) Incorrect – The passage does not mention international collaborations as a major challenge.

c) Incorrect – The private sector’s contribution is still low, not excessive.

d) Incorrect – The passage does not single out biotechnology as an underfunded field.

2.

Ans: b

Explanation:

The passage emphasizes that funding alone will not guarantee success unless India addresses its infrastructure gaps and encourages private sector involvement.

Reference:

"To truly transform India into a research powerhouse, the focus must shift to strengthening foundational infrastructure, incentivising private innovation, and ensuring long-term, sustainable engagement from industry leaders."

Why other options are incorrect?

a) Incorrect – The passage does not suggest reducing government funding; it calls for private sector involvement.

c) Incorrect – Increasing public sector sales turnover is not the main concern.

d) Incorrect – The passage does not emphasize military R&D as a priority.

3.

Ans: d

Explanation:

The passage notes that private sector participation in R&D remains inadequate, with government funding driving most scientific advancements.

Reference:

"India’s R&D landscape has long suffered from low private sector participation. While government funding has driven most scientific advancements, private investment in research has remained inadequate."

Why other options are incorrect?

a) Incorrect – The passage states India’s private sector spending is low, not high.

b) Incorrect – The government still dominates R&D funding.

c) Incorrect – India’s R&D spending is far below that of leading economies.

4.

Ans: b

Explanation:

The passage mentions that two of the world’s most advanced fighter jets, the Russian Su-57 and the American F-35, will be featured together for the first time, allowing aviation experts to compare their capabilities.

Reference:

"For the first time, the exposition will feature two of the world’s most advanced fighter jets, the Russian Su-57 and the American F-35."

Why other options are incorrect?

a) Incorrect – The passage does not mention UAVs as a highlight.

c) Incorrect – The passage does not claim this is the largest air display.

d) Incorrect – Both Indian and foreign jets will be displayed.

5.

Ans: c

Explanation:

The passage explains that the theme reflects India's dedication to cutting-edge defence advancements and international collaborations in aerospace.

Reference:

"The theme this year, ‘The Runway to a Billion Opportunities,’ encapsulates India’s commitment to fostering cutting-edge advancements in defence technology while opening new doors for international collaboration."

Why other options are incorrect?

a) Incorrect – The theme does not refer to a specific monetary goal.

b) Incorrect – The focus is not primarily on employment.

d) Incorrect – The phrase does not indicate a target of one billion projects.

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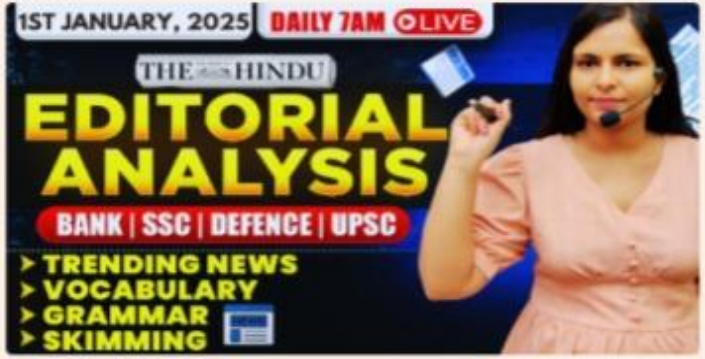

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